

NABW ORGANISATIONAL PROFILE



About Us



WHO WE ARE

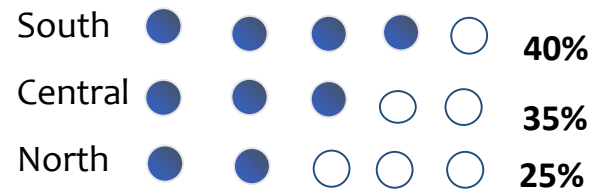
NABW is a women founded and led Non-profit and Non-governmental organisation dedicated to empowering women in business and leadership roles. Founded in 1990 as an NGO under the Trusteeship Act of 1962 of the Laws of Malawi. We operate across three key thematic areas: economic empowerment, social advocacy, and climate action. Our Mission is to empower and uplift the lives of women economically and socially through entrepreneurship development, skills training, market access, information dissemination, access to finance and advocacy

7,000

NABW boasts a diverse membership base comprising 7,000 women-led MSMEs



Location



35%

Youth
Members



65%

Women
Members

Our purpose



Vision

Liberated, socially empowered and economically active women of Malawi who contribute significantly to the political and economic development of Malawi



Mission

To empower and uplift the lives of women economically and socially through entrepreneurship development, skills training, market access, information dissemination, access to finance and advocacy among urban and rural women

Our values

01

Legitimacy

We always strive to be the legitimate voice for all women (not only our members) doing various businesses in Malawi

02

Resourceful

We always strive to be resourceful in order to generate all the needed expertise to help women in their business activities; and help entities in Malawi create environments where women businesses can prosper

03

Accountable

We are a membership led organization, and therefore, our members always inform what we do. Our members inform our direction and the strategies we take

04

Honesty

We always strive to be honest in all our undertakings within ourselves as a membership led organization as well as all partners and duty bearers we work with.

Thematic Areas

01

Economic Empowerment

NABW is committed to enhancing the economic status of women through various programs and initiatives aimed at supporting women entrepreneurs and professionals



Business Mentorship Programme

Provides resources, mentorship, and funding opportunities for women-owned startups and small businesses



Financial Literacy Workshops

Offers training sessions on budgeting, investing, and financial planning to help women gain financial independence



Microfinance Initiative

Facilitate access to low-interest loans and grants to women entrepreneurs to start or expand their businesses

02

Social Advocacy

We strive to address social issues affecting women and advocate for policies that promote gender equality and women's rights



Women's Leadership Trainings

A training program that equips women with leadership skills and knowledge to excel in various sectors



Advocacy Campaigns

Focuses on lobbying for gender-sensitive policies and legislation at local, national, and international levels



Community Outreach

Engages in community-based projects to raise awareness on issues like gender-based violence, health and social accountability



Climate Action & Renewable Energy

Recognizing the impact of climate change on communities, especially women, NABW integrates climate action and renewable energy into its core activities



Green Business Initiative

Encourages and supports women-led businesses to diversify to renewable energy enterprises and adopt sustainable practices and technologies.



Climate Education Programs

Provides educational resources and training on climate change and environmental sustainability



Green & Inclusive Energy Advocacy

We advocate for Increased participation of women in national energy planning, Investments and supply chain.

Meet our ED

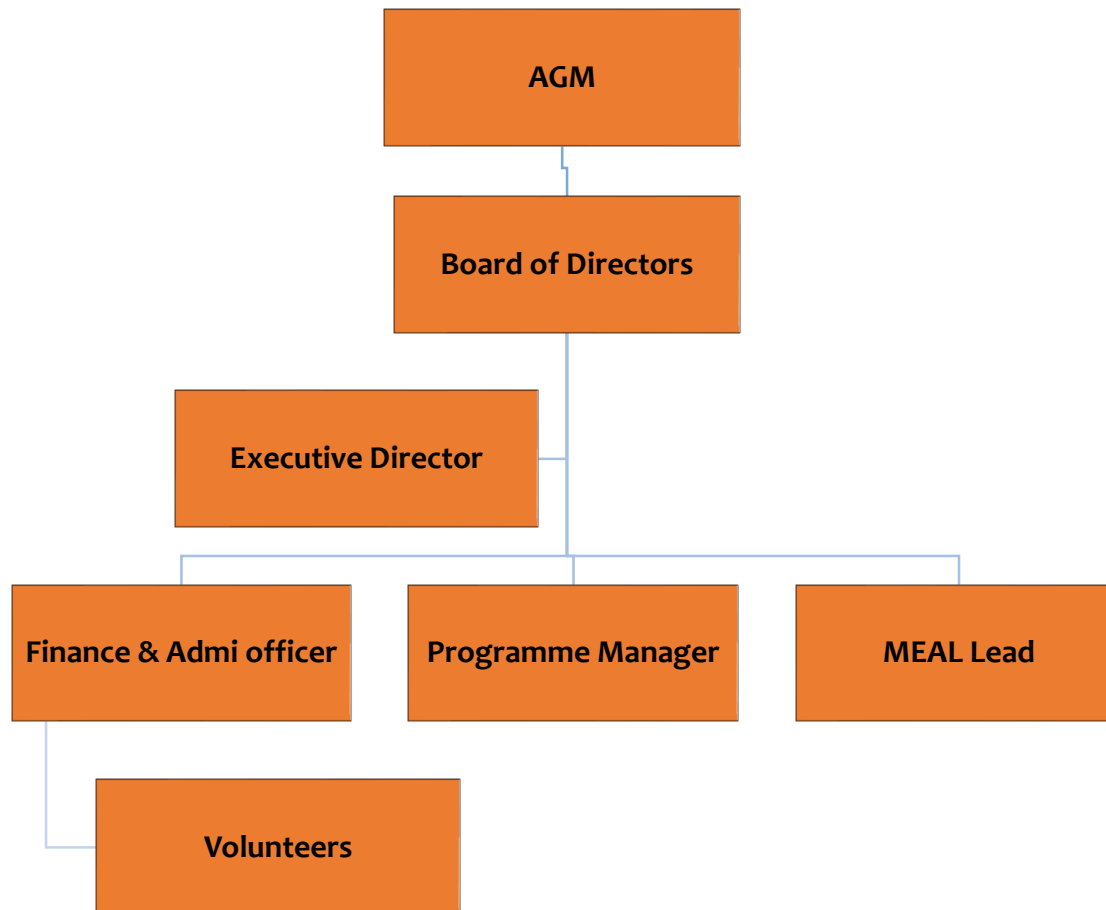


Barbara Banda

Executive Director with over 30 years experience in development management in sub-Saharan Africa region. She has served in various leadership positions, chairperson for NGO Gender Coordination Network and Former board member for National Economic Empowerment Fund. She holds MSc in Development Management

Our Structure

NABW has 7 board of directors composed of credible and professionally respected, trusted and experienced business women. These are elected at the Annual General Assembly to govern the operations of the organisation. The board has a mandate to recruit a visionary, experienced Executive Director to manage the daily operations of the organisation. At the technical level, it is composed of 4 permanent staff and 3 volunteers





Entrepreneurial behavior, life skills and Leadership

“Building strong foundations”

- Trained 77/90 women representing 85% of total targeted women
- Improved self-confidence and decision making abilities
- Atleast 80% of participants taking on leadership roles within their communities or business networks.

Financial Literacy, Management and Record Keeping

“Empowering financial independence”

- Trained 77/90 representing 85% of total targeted women
- Improved financial literacy: participants demonstrated an average of 85% increase in financial literacy knowledge
- Improved business management practices with 80 % reporting they implemented changes in their businesses.
- Record Keeping excellence; 90 % of participants now have organized financial records compared to less than 50% from the start of project.

E-commerce and digital Marketing

"Nurturing Online Presence"



Trained 90/90 representing 100% of the targeted women.

Successful adoption of e-commerce & digital marketing with 70% of participants established or improved their online presence.

70% increase in digital marketing knowledge and ability to create effective online marketing campaigns

← Hellen Nyirenda



Hellen Nyirenda · 3rd

Titemwanenge investments
Blantyre, Southern Region, Malawi, Malawi

15 connections

Connect Message

About

The company started two years ago. WE ARE IN AGRO BUSINESS, FARMING AND ADDING VALUE TO OUR FARM PRODUCTS. We farm yellow maize, soya we produce soya nutritious porridge. We also raise pigs and Chicken

Top skills
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Toricess Organic Farms
24 Oct

Honey still available for grabs @
8,000.00 per kg and 4,000.00 per 500g



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The Neem Honey. 100% Raw 100% Organic. Loaded with healing powers of the Neem tree. Order yours on 0885276216 or 0999399272 BT. We send everywhere.

K7,500/1kg
K4,000 /500g



← Chitenje fashions



Chitenje fashions

Chitenje Fashions is one of the small scale business which strives its best to provide maximum qual

WhatsApp

Page · Clothing (brand)

+265 999 21 85 55

mercymwalem@gmail.com



Product development and quality control

"Innovation and Quality Assurance"

- Trained 64/60 women entrepreneurs exceeding the target
- Quality improvements in products enhancing the competitiveness of women-led businesses in the market.
- New Product Development: 70 % of participants successfully developed or improved existing product contributing to business growth.

Mentorship program

"Guiding Paths to Success"

- Trained 28/30 representing 93% of the targeted mentors
- Each assigned atleast 3 mentees
- Program Assist in business formalization impacting credibility of women businesses

Building Back Better After Climate Related Events



From 2023-2024, NABW is receiving Technical Assistance from the Investment Climate Reform (ICR) Facility to support women owned businesses to build back better after climate related events and other external shocks.

As the incidence of such events has increased in Malawi in recent years, the lack of business risk assessment tools and mitigation strategies have negatively impacted the ability of women owned businesses to recover. The key outputs from this initiative will be (i) a technical study that will assess the current situation and make recommendations as to how to support women owned businesses through policy, programmes and products; (ii) a training manual for use by NABW and their partners to support women owned businesses, supported by associated training; and (iii) a policy brief and gender climate checklist to highlight key actions for business environment reform

Promoting Insurance Coverage among Women-owned Businesses

This project was designed to due the aftermath of Cyclone Freddy. The cyclone resulted in the significant loss of products, capital, and markets, for SMEs especially women-owned SMEs which most of them were uncertain about how they will recover from the cyclone shocks. NABW recognizes that climate change-related hazards such as cyclone Freddy will continue to pose a threat to SMEs, and promoting insurance coverage among women-owned businesses is an essential step towards mitigating and adapting to these risks and promoting economic rights.

We conducted a quick mini survey, aimed to gain an understanding of insurance companies operating in Malawi, specifically those offering products tailored to benefit women-owned SMEs.

In partnership with CIC-Africa Cooperative Insurance Limited, we conducted awareness campaign meetings in the 10 districts affected by cyclone Freddy with NABW members eencouraging women-owned businesses to invest in insurance policies that can protect them from climate-related risks.



In 2022, NABW with financial support from Urgent Action Fund implemented a six months project called SheActs4Feminomics project which is run by a consortium of Five Civil Society Organisations namely; For Equality, CEWAG, MHRRC, and Chikulamayembe Women Forum. The project aimed to address macro-level policies and their role in shaping policies that impact women's economic justice and rights, to achieve greater impact in Malawi. Specifically, NABW' objective in this intervention was to strengthen macro-level policy and regulatory frameworks to address challenges faced by women owned SMEs.

We conducted the following workshops;

1. Gender mainstreaming in SMEs policies, strategies and programmes workshop.
2. Policy dialogue on Public procurement and business formalization
3. Plenary session on achieving economic justice for women owned SMEs

SheActs4Feminomics



Advocacy & Campaigns



BUSINESS WOMEN SUMMIT

19 TH APRIL 2021
AT 10:00 AM

THE LAUNCH OF GENDER RESPONSIVE PROCUREMENT AND FINANCIAL INCLUSION INITIATIVE #10 BILLION KWACHA WOMEN'S FUND

REALIZING GENDER RESPONSIVE PROCUREMENT AND SMART-INCLUSIVE FINANCING

OUR GUEST SPEAKER

HIS EXCELLENCY LAZARUS MCCARTHY CHAKWERA
THE PRESIDENT OF THE REPUBLIC OF MALAWI

 **Dr Joyce Banda**
Former President Of The Republic Malawi & Founder Of NABW

 **Madam Ellen Johnson Sirleaf**
President Of The African Leaders Network

 **Hon Dr Patricia Kaliati**
Minister Of Gender, Community Development & Social Welfare



In 2020, NABW led a Financial Inclusion and Gender Responsive Procurement Advocacy campaign through a workshop that was attended by the State President and cabinet ministers. Private sector participants included banks and business development consultants. As a result a Financial Inclusion Index has been developed to monitor financial institutions.

Beijing Declaration Platform for Action + 25

In a year 2020, with funding from Urgent Action Fund, NABW and other CSOs like NGO GCN, MHRRC, WOLREC and MBAWEMI conducted consultations where we were obligated to look into achievements and gaps that we have been able to implement since the adoption of the BPFA in 1995.

Questions that were needed to be answered includes, what has not worked, what are the new emerging challenges for women and what could be done to forge ahead.

Twenty five years after the adoption of Beijing Platform for Action, do more women and girls have access to free quality education, reproduction health and rights services and whether there is a gradual increase in women positions of power and decision making



GREEN & INCLUSIVE ENERGY-GIE

Hivos 5-year funded project started in 2016-2020 to help alleviate the energy poverty situation in southern Africa through lobby and advocacy to influence the debate on energy, with the ultimate aim of making energy systems more green and inclusive (for women, children and the marginalized). It envisioned a green and inclusive energy system that creates economic opportunities and growth whilst mitigating climate change.

In Malawi the GIE project had the same focus of evidence-based advocacy including building capacities among stakeholders for their participation in the energy sector. The partners implementing the project in Malawi were; National Association of Business Women (NABW), Community Energy Malawi (CEM), Malawi Health Equity Network (MHEN), Youth Network and Counselling (YONECO) and Renewable Malawi.

NABW's role was to establish a 'Gender and Energy Platform' in Malawi and to support consortium members to achieve the objective to meet the energy needs of women and youth in their activities. NABW, in view of its national representation of women run businesses will build the capacities of its members to participate in the energy supply chain including access to energy investment opportunities





OUR PARTNERS

NABW works and collaborates with other likeminded organisations, actors and networks. These also includes those that support our work

1. Urgent Africa Fund
2. Christian Aid Malawi
3. NGO Gender Coordination Network
4. World University Service of Canada- WUSC
5. Hivos Peoples Unlimited
6. Graca' Machel Trust –GMT
7. National Economic Empowerment Fund
8. British Council
9. GIZ Malawi
10. CIC insurance Limited
11. Dreams Microfinance
12. First Capital Bank
13. Fines Project- Reserve Bank of Malawi
14. Micro-loan Foundation
15. For Equality
16. Mbawemi
17. Cross Boarder Traders Association
18. Malawi Union of SMEs
19. SMEDI
20. CISONECC
21. Line Ministries (Trade, Gender, Energy, Agriculture,)
22. Malawi Bureau of Standards

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Website: nabwmalawi.wixsite.com/website

